

COM File

A type of executable file that is limited to 64 KB. These simple files are often used for utility programs and small routines. Because COM files are executable, viruses can infect them. This file type has the extension COM.

Cookie

Cookies are blocks of text placed in a file on your computer's hard disk. Web sites use cookies to identify users who revisit the site. Cookies might contain login or registration information, "shopping cart" information or user preferences. When a server receives a browser request that includes a cookie, the server can use the information stored in the cookie to customise the Web site for the user. Cookies can be used to gather more information about a user than would be possible without them.

DDoS

Distributed Denial of Service. Attempts to DoS large sites using most forms of resource exhaustion attack, and particularly network bandwidth wasting strategies, are often impossible for a single attacking machine because of the sheer scale of resources available to the attacked site.

Denial of Service, DoS

An attack on a computer system intended to reduce, or entirely block, the level of service that 'legitimate clients' can receive from that system. These range in scope from network bandwidth wasting and/or swamping through exhausting various machine resources (such as memory, disk space, thread or process handles) required by the process(es) providing the service. They usually work by exploiting vulnerabilities that eventually crash the service process or the underlying system. Although not commonly associated with viruses, denial of service components are included in some viral payload routines.

Destructiveness

This is measured based on the amount of damage that a malicious program can possibly achieve once a computer has been infected.